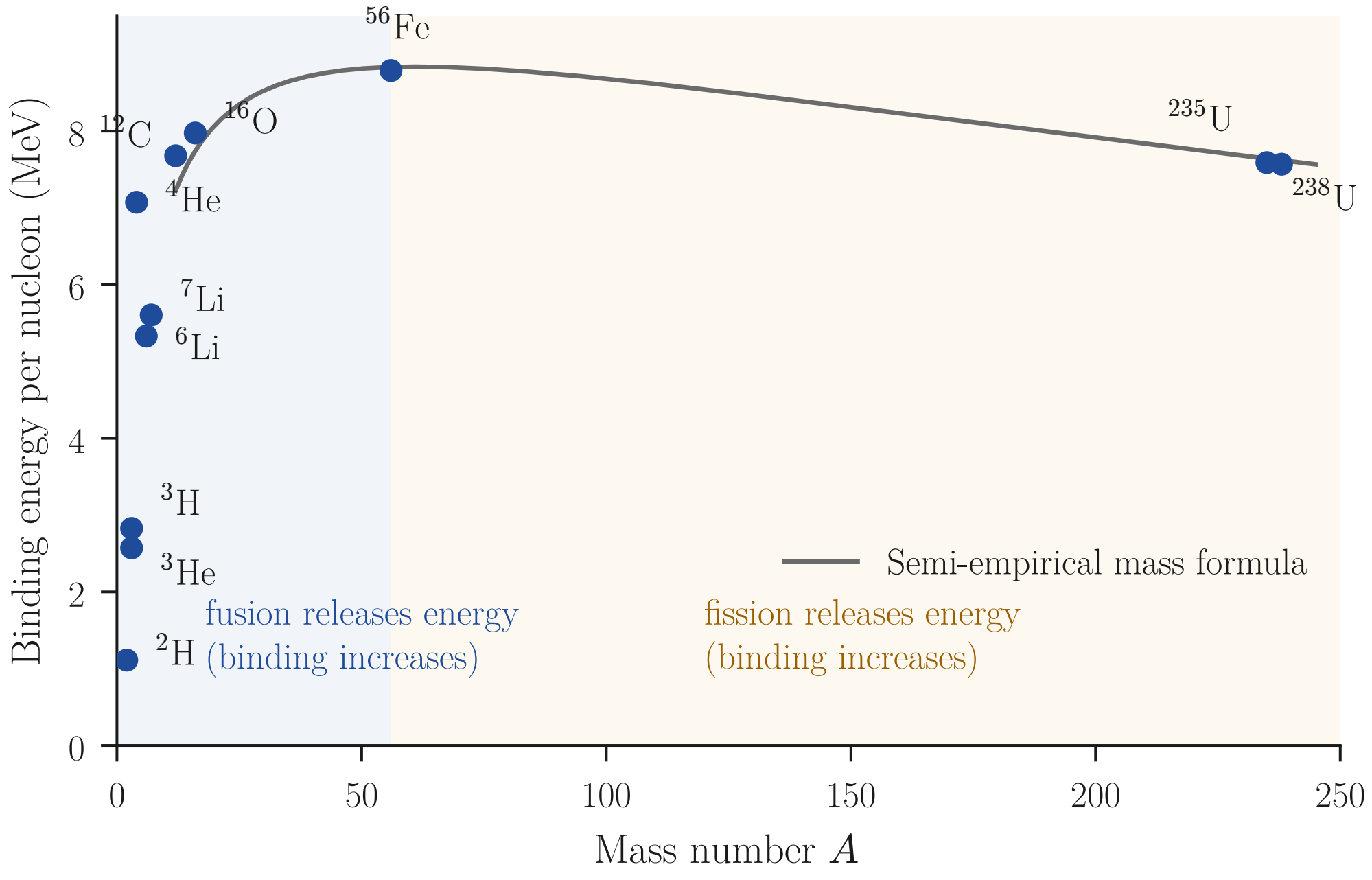
Binding energy per nucleon (MeV)
Mass number A
0
2
4
6
8
0
50
100
150
200
250
^{56}Fe
^{16}O
^{12}C
^{4}He
^{7}Li
^{6}Li
^{3}H
^{3}He
^{2}H
^{235}U
^{238}U
Semi-empirical mass formula
fusion releases energy
(binding increases)
fission releases energy
(binding increases)